

JAMES WILD & CO.

INDONESIA

RAJA AMPAT, KOMODO & BALI, UNDER SAIL

A complimentary field guide to Indonesia's phinisi yacht voyages, reefs and island villas, from an explorer who sailed Raja Ampat in 2024.

PREPARED FOR
Jane Traveler

START HERE
MEET IGGI

FIELD GUIDE NO. 02 · EDITION 2027
FOLIO JW-F-0002
COVER PHOTO: DUNIA BARU



HI, I'M IGGI · JAMES'S TRIP-BUILDING BUDDY

Every place in here is a page number. Circle the ones that make you grin, then find **Iggi's Compass** on the Indonesia page at jameswildco.com. Tell me your month and your crew; I'll sketch the voyage, James takes it from there. *Never lost. Only scenic.*

Dear Jane,

In November 2024 I sailed Raja Ampat aboard Aliikai with my son. We dropped in off Kri on the first morning and the reef simply didn't end: fusiliers in rivers, a turtle that couldn't have cared less about us, coral in colours I don't have names for. I've been diving for more than forty years, and I came up laughing.

Indonesia is too big to see, so don't try. Seventeen thousand islands is not an itinerary. Pick a sea, pick the right boat, and give it time. The right boat is a phinisi: a wooden schooner built by hand on the beaches of South Sulawesi, the way they have been for generations.

Then come ashore. Bali is where most of these voyages begin or end, and it deserves more than a night by the airport: rice terraces and temple ceremonies around Ubud, a cliff over the Indian Ocean on the Bukit. Land, then sea. You should feel the change.

J. Wild CHIEF EXPEDITION OFFICER · SAILED RAJA AMPAT, NOV 2024



ISLANDS
17,380
counted by Indonesia's geospatial agency in 2024

CORAL
~600
reef-building species in Raja Ampat, about three-quarters of the world's known total

THE BOATS
2017
phinisi boatbuilding joins UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list

Contents

Read it in order, west to east. Or start with the page that made you pick it up. Each part has its own colour, at the top of every page.

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HOW TO READ THE MARKS

● I KNOW A PLACE	James has stayed or sailed there himself.
● I KNOW WHO KNOWS	Vetted through a partner we trust.
● I'LL KNOW SOON	On James's list, honestly marked.
● I KEEP GOING BACK	A founder favourite.

THE COLOURS OF THIS GUIDE

Forest, sage, sand and linen: the house palette for every James Wild & Co. guide.

FOREST · SAGE · SAND · LINEN · INK

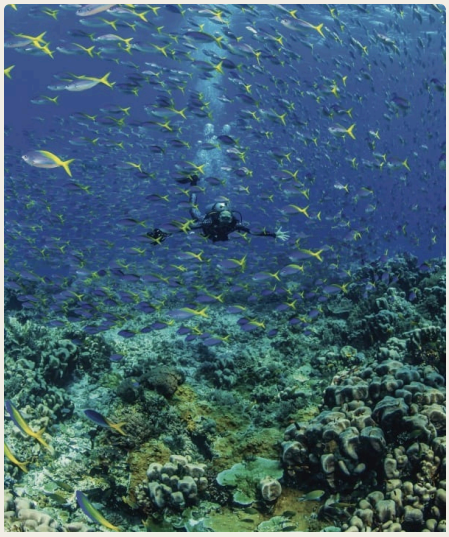
The middle of the Coral Triangle

Why sail Indonesia: the world's richest reefs, hand-built wooden yachts and island cultures you can still walk into.



WEST · BALI & KOMODO · DRY-SEASON VOYAGES

EAST · RAJA AMPAT & BANDA · THE DEEP REEFS



Inside the shoal PHOTO: TO CONFIRM

Reefs you can't exaggerate

Raja Ampat sits where the Pacific and Indian oceans meet, at the heart of the Coral Triangle. Surveys here have counted almost 600 species of reef-building coral and more than 1,200 kinds of fish. You don't need to dive: a mask and snorkel off the tender is plenty.

Boats with a bloodline

The phinisi is the two-masted schooner of South Sulawesi, still built by hand on the beaches of Tana Beru and Bira. The best of them now carry a dive centre, a chef and a crew of fifteen or more for a dozen guests.

Islands with a culture

Bali's temple calendar, the Abui villages of Alor, the nutmeg forts of Banda. A good voyage spends as much time ashore as under water.

> *Indonesia rewards the second week. You spend the first one learning how big it is.*
>
> — J. WILD

Pick the sea first, then the month

The best time to sail Indonesia depends on the sea: Raja Ampat from October to April, Komodo and Bali from April to November.

	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Raja Ampat	●	●	●	●	○	○	○	○	○	●	●	●
Misool	●	●	●	●	○	○	○	○	○	●	●	●
Komodo	○	○	○	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	○
Banda & Alor	○	○	●	●	○	○	○	○	●	●	●	○
Bali, ashore	○	○	○	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	○	○

● Prime months for phinisi voyages and calm seas ○ Possible, with more wind, rain or swell. Guidance only; every yacht confirms its season.

OCTOBER – APRIL

The Raja Ampat season

Calmer water in the east, the reefs at their clearest, and the karst lagoons of Wayag and Misool at their best.

APRIL – NOVEMBER

Komodo & Bali, dry season

Dry hills, steady winds and good visibility in Komodo. Bali's driest months for temples, rice terraces and the cliffs.



Komodo's ridges are greenest just after the rains

PHOTO: DUNIA BARU

> *The archipelago is big enough that it's always the right season somewhere. Tell me the month you can travel, and I'll tell you which sea.*
>
> — J. WILD

Who Indonesia by sea is for, and who it isn't

The short answer: anyone who loves the water, and nobody in a hurry. Here's how I'd match you.

BEST FOR	IDEAL LENGTH	BEST TIME	HOW
Divers, sailors and anyone who likes their luxury barefoot	10 to 16 days: a week at sea, a few nights ashore	Raja Ampat Oct–Apr; Komodo and Bali Apr–Nov	Private phinisi charter, then villas on Bali

MADE FOR YOU IF YOU'RE…

First-timers
Bali first, then the dragons. You'll understand why people stay longer.

OUR PICK · THE CONTRAST · BALI, THEN KOMODO

Divers & snorkelers
Raja Ampat will spoil every other reef for you. Sorry in advance.

OUR PICK · ALIIKAI OR DUNIA BARU · OCT–APR

Families & three generations
One boat, one table, nobody's phone works. Bliss.

OUR PICK · DUNIA BARU · THE WHOLE YACHT

Couples & honeymooners
Three cabins, a wooden deck and a sunset nobody else is watching.

OUR PICK · SI DATU BUA · 6 GUESTS

Wellness seekers
A river, rice terraces and someone who knows your name by day two.

OUR PICK · COMO SHAMBHALA ESTATE, UBUD

The culture-curious
Temple ceremonies in Ubud, the Abui on Alor, the spice forts of Banda.

OUR PICK · SILOLONA · THE SPICE ISLANDS

THINK TWICE IF YOU'RE…

Bad sailors
A phinisi rolls; it's part of her charm. Some nights you'll disagree.

OUR PICK · BALI VILLAS, THEN A SHORT KOMODO CRUISE

Nightlife hunters
Seminyak has it. The rest of Indonesia has better things to do.

OUR PICK · TWO NIGHTS IN SEMINYAK, THEN OUT

Anyone in a hurry
The flights alone take a day. Come for two weeks, or wait.

OUR PICK · STRETCH TO TWELVE NIGHTS

Limited mobility
Tender transfers, boarding ladders, steep village paths.

OUR PICK · BALI VILLAS AND A GENTLER ROUTE

Signal addicts
Raja Ampat has more fish than phone signal.

OUR PICK · SATELLITE ON BOARD FOR EMERGENCIES

Minimum ages and dive certification rules vary by yacht [confirm per yacht]. Not sure where you fit? Ask Iggi, or call me.

Six places worth the passage

Where to go in Indonesia by sea, west to east, with the mark each place has earned.

JAMES SAYS DON'T MISS THIS ONE



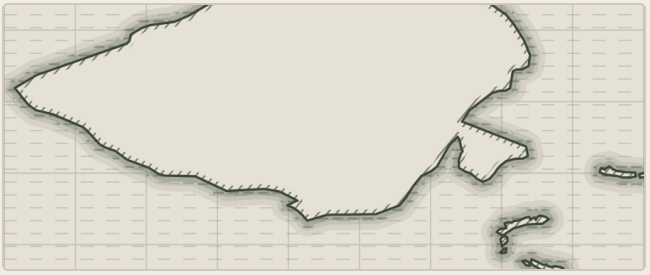
Raja Ampat

I KNOW A PLACE · SAILED 2024

The Four Kings

Wayag's karst lagoons, the reefs off Kri and Mansuar, mantas at Arborek and the lookout over Piaynemo.

DIVES & LOOKOUTS · ALIIKAI · DUNIA BARU



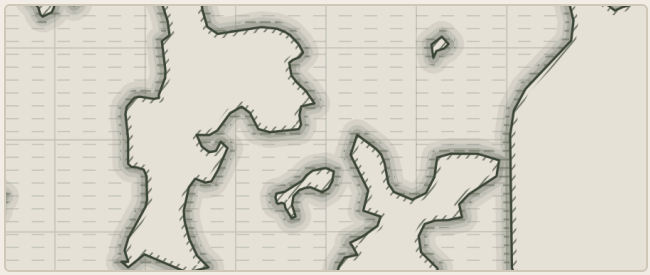
Misool

I KNOW WHO KNOWS

The southern gardens

Soft corals in every colour, ancient rock art and hidden karst lagoons. The quieter half of Raja Ampat.

DIVES & KAYAKS · SILOLONA · DUNIA BARU



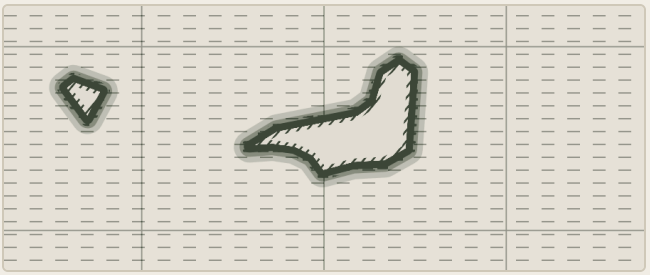
Komodo

I KNOW WHO KNOWS

The dragons

Dragons on Komodo and Rinca, the three-bay view from Padar, manta points and a pink-sand beach.

RANGER WALKS & DIVES · ALL FOUR YACHTS



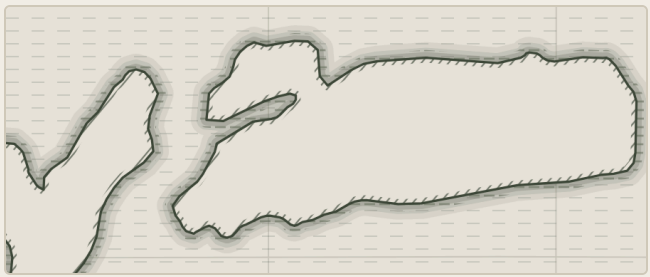
Banda

I KNOW WHO KNOWS

The Spice Islands

Nutmeg groves, Dutch forts and a volcano over Banda Neira, with reefs that start at the jetty.

VILLAGE & REEF · SILOLONA



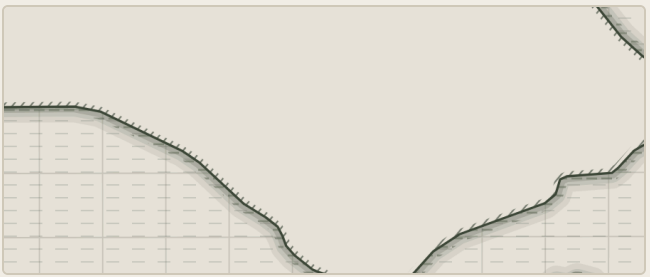
Alor

I KNOW WHO KNOWS

The far reefs

Cold, clear walls and Abui villages in the hills. Few boats ever make it this far.

WALLS & VILLAGES · DUNIA BARU · SILOLONA



Bali

I'LL KNOW SOON

The island of gods

Rice terraces and temples around Ubud, black-sand beaches in Tabanan, the Bukit's cliffs over the Indian Ocean.

VILLAS & TEMPLES · SIX STAYS · SEE STAYS

Marks are samples for layout; James confirms each one before release.

By sea, by land, or both

A phinisi charter, Bali villas, or both in one trip: how the three compare.

	BY SEA · A PHINISI	BY LAND · BALI VILLAS	BOTH · THE CONTRAST
Where you sleep	One cabin that moves with you	A villa, usually with its own pool	Four nights on Bali, then the yacht
Reach	Raja Ampat, Komodo, Banda, Alor	Ubud, the southwest coast, the Bukit	Bali, then Komodo
Pace	Two or three dives or swims a day	Temples, spas, slow mornings	Slow, then wild
Suits	Divers, families on charter, sailors	Wellness, culture, design lovers	First-timers with eleven days
Nights · from	5–14 · $[___] pp	3 or more · $[___] pp	4 + 6 · $[___] pp



Your cabin, carved in teak PHOTO: DUNIA BARU



The aft deck, where the day ends PHOTO: DUNIA BARU

THE LINGER-O-METER · THE SAME ARCHIPELAGO AT THREE SPEEDS

7
DAYS · KOMODO BY PHINISI
Dragons, Padar's ridge, mantas and a pink beach.
You miss: Bali, and the eastern reefs.

11
DAYS · THE CONTRAST
Ubud and the Bukit, then six nights among the dragons.
You miss: Raja Ampat. Next time.

14
DAYS · THE FOUR KINGS
Raja Ampat north, then south to Misool, one cabin.
You miss: nothing but the office.

The Four Kings

ITN-VSL-2026-302558 · ALIIKAI · 14 GUESTS · 7 CABINS · SORONG ROUND TRIP

● I KNOW A PLACE · SAILED NOV 2024



Sample order: Sorong · Kri · Arborek · Piaynemo · Wayag · the northern passages · Mansuar · Batanta. The captain sets the order by weather.



Wayag from the summit GETTY IMAGES



Aliikai's aft deck, 2024 ALIIKAI



Straight off the tender DUNIA BARU

DAY 1	**Board at Sorong.** Sail overnight into the Dampier Strait.
DAYS 2–3	**Kri, Mansuar & Arborek.** Reef dives off the jetty and the mantas' cleaning station.
DAY 4	**Piaynemo.** Up the steps to the lookout over the karst lagoons.
DAYS 5–6	**Wayag.** The postcard islands, by kayak and from the summit.
DAYS 7–8	**The Passage & Wofoh.** Narrow channels, mangroves and quiet anchorages.
DAYS 9–10	**Batanta, then Sorong.** A last dive, a waterfall walk, and home.

WHO IT SUITS

Divers and snorkelers, families, and anyone who wants Raja Ampat's north in one go. Whole-yacht charter for 14.

FROM

US$4,830 pp · 9 nights [confirm]

TIME REWARDED

Add Misool for the Four Kings, 14 days: [__] off the second week.

TR-RAJ-JW-F-0002

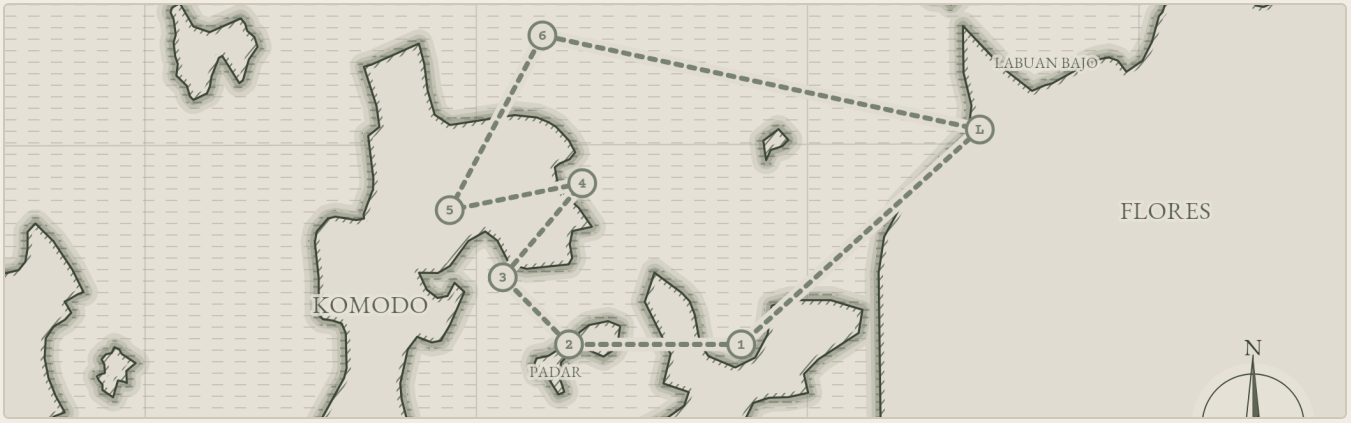
Like this one? Tap Iggi's Compass and start from this route.

> *Go in the calm months, and give Wayag two days. One to see it, one to believe it.*
> — J. WILD

Dragons & Pink Sand

SAMPLE CHARTER · DUNIA BARU · 14 GUESTS · 7 CABINS · LABUAN BAJO ROUND TRIP

I KNOW WHO KNOWS



Sample loop: Labuan Bajo · Rinca · Padar · Pink Beach · Manta point · Komodo · Gili Lawa. Park rangers set walking times.



Yes, they swim DUNIA BARU



The crew sets up the sandbar DUNIA BARU



Under sail, Flores Sea DUNIA BARU

DAY 1	**Labuan Bajo.** Board in the afternoon; sail at sunset.
DAY 2	**Rinca.** A ranger walk among the dragons, then a reef.
DAY 3	**Padar & Pink Beach.** The three-bay view at dawn, a swim on the pink sand.
DAY 4	**Manta point.** Drift with the mantas when the current is right.
DAY 5	**Komodo.** The dragons' home island, and the crew's sandbar lunch.
DAYS 6–7	**Gili Lawa, then Labuan Bajo.** A last summit at sunrise and back for the flight.

WHO IT SUITS

Families and three generations, and groups up to 14 who want the whole yacht and a dive shop on board.

FROM

Charter $[____] per week

CHARTER THE WHOLE SHIP

Seven nights or more: [__] included.

CWS-KOM-JW-F-0002

Like this one? Tap Iggi's Compass and start from this route.

> *Take the dawn walk on Padar. It's the photograph everyone wants, and almost nobody gets up for.*
> — J. WILD

The Contrast

JW-CON-I01 · 4 NIGHTS ON BALI, THEN 6 NIGHTS IN KOMODO BY PHINISI · 11 DAYS

● I KEEP GOING BACK · THE JAMES WILD WAY



Bali, four nights · then a one-hour flight east to Labuan Bajo and the yacht.



Lunch is wherever the sandbar is DUNIA BARU



Dinner on deck DUNIA BARU



Whale shark season DUNIA BARU

DAYS 1–2	**Ubud.** COMO Shambhala or Viceroy Bali: rice terraces, a temple ceremony, a long massage.
DAYS 3–4	**The Bukit.** A cliff-top villa at Ungasan; sunset over the Indian Ocean.
DAY 5	**Fly to Labuan Bajo.** Board Si Datu Bua or Silolona by the afternoon.
DAYS 6–10	**Komodo by phinisi.** Dragons, Padar, mantas and empty sandbars.
DAY 11	**Fly home.** Via Bali, or straight on.

WHO IT SUITS

First-timers with eleven days, couples, and anyone nervous about a first night at sea.

FROM

$[____] pp · 10 nights

THE CONTRAST RATE

Villas plus yacht, priced together: [__].

CON-IDN-JW-F-0002

Like this one? Tap Iggi's Compass and start from this route.

> *Good journeys have seams. Land, then sea. You should feel the change.*
> — J. WILD

Every boat we'd put you on

Four wooden phinisi, all chartered whole, with crew, chef, dive team and every meal. Six to fourteen guests, so the reef is never crowded.

THE FLEET APPROVED CHARTER THE WHOLE SHIP

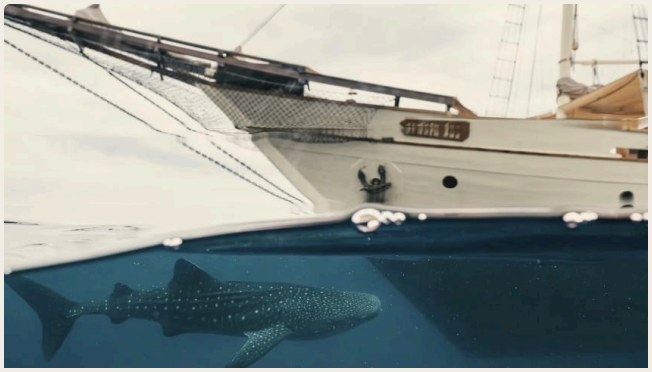


PHOTO: SILOLONA JOURNEYS

Silolona

I KNOW WHO KNOWS

PHINISI · ABOUT 50 M [CONFIRM] · 5 CABINS · 10 GUESTS · 17 CREW · VIA SILOLONA JOURNEYS

One of the yachts that started luxury sailing in Indonesia. Konjo-built, with a PADI dive centre, three tenders, kayaks and paddleboards. The Spice Islands specialist.

PHOTO TO COME FROM SILOLONA JOURNEYS

Si Datu Bua

I KNOW WHO KNOWS

PHINISI · 40 M · 3 CABINS · 6 GUESTS · ABOUT 11 CREW · VIA SILOLONA JOURNEYS

Silolona's smaller sister. Three cabins, the same crew culture and a dive centre on board. Our pick for couples and small families.



PHOTO: DUNIA BARU

Dunia Baru

I KNOW WHO KNOWS

PHINISI · 51 M · 7 CABINS · 14 GUESTS · 18 CREW · BUILT 2014

Konjo-built with superyacht systems: a full dive shop, jet skis, a Sunfish, a library and a teppanyaki grill. The one for families and big groups.



PHOTO: ALIIKAI

Aliikai

I KNOW A PLACE · SAILED 2024

PHINISI · 40 M · 7 CABINS · 14 GUESTS · 13 CREW · BUILT IN BULUKUMBA, SULAWESI

I sailed Raja Ampat aboard her in November 2024. Thirteen crew for fourteen guests, a dive deck that runs like a watch, and a sundeck I'd happily never leave.

> *Pick the sea, then the boat. A great yacht in the wrong month is still the wrong month.*
> — J. WILD

Specifications from published charter listings; confirm with each yacht before booking. Marks are samples until confirmed.

Six stays, before or after the boat

Where to stay in Bali around a yacht charter: the hills of Ubud for culture, the coast for sea air.



1 COMO Shambhala · 2 Viceroy · 3 Kayumanis Ubud · 4 Soori · 5 Hotel Indigo · 6 Kayumanis Jimbaran · 7 Ungasan Clifftop · 8 Kayumanis Nusa Dua

> *Split Bali in two: the green hills of Ubud for the culture, the coast for the sea air. Two nights each, minimum.*
>
> — J. WILD

Details from published property listings; confirm with each property. Partner photography to follow.

1 **COMO Shambhala Estate** — I'LL KNOW SOON

UBUD HIGHLANDS · BY THE AYUNG RIVER

A residential wellness retreat in the jungle above a river gorge, with a personal consultant who builds your spa and yoga programme.

Best for: A real reset before or after the boat.

2 **Viceroy Bali** — I'LL KNOW SOON

UBUD · ON THE PETANU RIVER GORGE

Forty private pool villas on the edge of a ravine, five minutes from Ubud. Apéritif is one of the island's best dining rooms.

Best for: Couples, and dinner as the event.

3 · 6 · 8 **Kayumanis** — I'LL KNOW SOON

UBUD · JIMBARAN · NUSA DUA

Three small private-villa estates, each walled and quiet, with the Kayumanis Spa. Jungle at Ubud or the beach towns of the south.

Best for: Privacy, villa by villa.

4 **Soori Bali** — I'LL KNOW SOON

TABANAN · THE BLACK-SAND COAST

About forty-five pool villas between rice fields and a black-sand beach, designed by the architect Soo K Chan.

Best for: Families and design lovers.

5 **Hotel Indigo Bali Seminyak Beach** — I'LL KNOW SOON

SEMINYAK · ON THE BEACH

A lively beach hotel styled on Balinese songket weaving, walking distance from Seminyak's restaurants and shops.

Best for: Two easy nights at the start or end.

7 **The Ungasan Clifftop Resort** — I'LL KNOW SOON

UNGASAN · THE BUKIT CLIFFS

Seven five-bedroom villas on the clifftop above the Indian Ocean, with private butlers and a beach club at the foot of the cliff.

Best for: Big families, friends and celebrations.

Slower is the whole point

Why seven nights at sea is the house minimum, and the offers that reward staying longer.

HOUSE RULE
7 NIGHTS
MINIMUM AT SEA



Worth another night, at anchor PHOTO: DUNIA BARU

Most Indonesia regrets are about time, not money. People fly a very long way, see one sea, and spend the flight home wondering about the others. We'd rather you stayed.

> *Seven nights or don't bother. The first two you sleep off the flights. Then the reef starts talking.*
> — J. WILD

TIME REWARDED

The Four Kings

Raja Ampat north and Misool, 14 days, one cabin: [__] off the second week.

TR-RAJ-JW-F-0002

WORTH ANOTHER NIGHT

A third night in Ubud

[offer to confirm with the property]

WAN-BAL-JW-F-0002

ON THE HORIZON

The Spice Islands

Banda and Alor between the monsoons, with early-planner savings of [__].

OTH-IDN-JW-F-0002

Codes are tied to your Folio ID so your advisor sees which offer you chose.

The Indonesia entries

Every place, ship and villa carries one mark. It tells you exactly how well we know it.

JAMES WILD & CO. LEDGERED & VETTED · SINCE 1982

ENTRY	PLACE	MARK	MARGIN NOTE
L-201	Aliikai · Raja Ampat	I KNOW A PLACE	*Thirteen crew, fourteen guests, and a dive deck that runs like a watch.*
L-202	Dunia Baru · Komodo & Raja Ampat	I KNOW WHO KNOWS	*The dive shop alone is better equipped than most resorts.*
L-203	Silolona · Spice Islands	I KNOW WHO KNOWS	*The pioneer. Ask about Banda in the shoulder season.*
L-204	Si Datu Bua · Komodo	I KNOW WHO KNOWS	*Three cabins. Bring the people you actually like.*
L-205	COMO Shambhala Estate · Ubud	I'LL KNOW SOON	*On the list for my next run to Bali.*
L-206	Soori Bali · Tabanan	I'LL KNOW SOON	*Black sand, rice fields, and very good architecture.*

Sample entries for layout. Every mark is confirmed by James before release.

RULES OF THE ROAD

01 **Pick the sea before the ship.** The month decides the water; the water decides everything.

02 **The smaller the boat, the bigger the sea.** Six to fourteen guests, never more.

03 **Arrive the day before the day before.** Domestic flights run late; yachts sail on the tide.

04 **Land, then sea.** Bali first, so the yacht is the reward.

WORDS WE'VE STRUCK OUT

~~paradise~~	Overused, and paradise is usually crowded. These places aren't.
~~undiscovered~~	The Bajau sea nomads and the Konjo boatbuilders got here centuries before us.
~~once in a lifetime~~	Most of our guests come back for the next sea. Plan for twice.

What to know, and what not to expect

Getting to Raja Ampat and Komodo, park fees, fitness, packing and straight answers.

Getting there

Fly into Bali (Denpasar). Komodo is about an hour east to Labuan Bajo; Raja Ampat starts at Sorong, usually via Jakarta or Makassar. Arrive a day early.

Fees at the door

Bali's tourist levy, IDR 150,000 per foreign visitor. Indonesia's visa on arrival or e-visa [confirm current fee]. Raja Ampat marine park entry card and Komodo National Park fees [confirm]; most yachts arrange the permits.

Fitness

Tender transfers, boarding ladders and the odd steep lookout. Confident swimmers get the most from the reefs; dive courses can be arranged on board.

Pack

Reef-safe sunscreen, a rash vest, light long sleeves and a sarong for temples, water shoes, a dry bag, and your dive card if you have one.

What not to expect

~~Casino~~	The only gamble is whether the mantas show up.
~~Formal nights~~	Dress code: barefoot by dinner.
~~On-time flights~~	Domestic schedules are suggestions. We build in a buffer.
~~Crowded reefs~~	Not where we take you.
~~Strong Wi-Fi~~	Limited at sea. Post the photos at home.

Straight answers

Do I need to dive? No. Most sites are as good with a mask and snorkel.

Sea or land first time? Land first. Then the yacht feels like a reward.

Children? Strong fit on Dunia Baru and Aliikai. Age guidance [confirm per yacht].

Words you'll hear on board

Phinisi
The two-masted wooden schooner of South Sulawesi. Its boatbuilding craft is on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list.

Konjo
The boatbuilding people of the Bira and Tana Beru coast, where most of these yachts were built by hand.

Coral Triangle
The ocean region between Indonesia, the Philippines and Papua New Guinea with the world's richest reefs.

Karst
Limestone worn into towers, mushrooms and lagoons. Wayag and Misool are karst country.

Tender
The small boat that takes you from yacht to shore or dive site.

Subak
Bali's cooperative system for sharing water across the rice terraces, run through the temples.

Ranger walk
Every walk among the Komodo dragons is led by a park ranger carrying a forked stick. Stay close.

Terima kasih
Thank you, in Bahasa Indonesia. The crew will teach you the rest.

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COLOPHON
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When I'd like to go	
Who's coming	
Sea, land or both	☐ A phinisi ☐ Bali villas ☐ The Contrast
The sea I circled	☐ Raja Ampat ☐ Komodo ☐ Banda & Alor
Something to celebrate	

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A LAST WORD FROM JAMES

Jane, that's Indonesia as I've come to know it, from a dive deck in Raja Ampat to a cliff on Bali. Circle what moves you, cross out what doesn't, and send it back. I'll read every mark. Seventeen thousand islands will wait; let's pick the right one.

Til our next expedition, James

James Papagno · Chief Expedition Officer · james@jameswildco.com · 561.479.6355 · jameswildco.com/voyages?src=fg02

PHOTOGRAPHS Dunia Baru (cover, vessel, Komodo and on-board photography), used with permission; Silolona Journeys [credit to confirm]; Aliikai Voyage; Getty Images (licensed): Wayag Bay, Raja Ampat; diver and reef photograph [credit to confirm].
MAPS Plates drawn by James Wild & Co. from Natural Earth public-domain data; small islands approximate.
SOURCES Island count: Badan Informasi Geospasial (2024). Coral and fish counts: Conservation International surveys of the Bird's Head Seascape. Phinisi: UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage, 2017. Bali levy: Bali provincial government, from 14 February 2024. Yacht and property details from published listings; confirm before booking.
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EDITION 2027